XMBA200S: Data and Decisions
Section Syllabus

Haas School of Business, UC Berkeley
Fall 2026

GSI: Silvia Farina (she/her)
E-mail: sfarina@berkeley.edu

Office Hours

Weekly on **Tuesday 5-6pm PST** - from 9/15
@ this zoom link

Please come to office hours for any question you might have about the material covered in class and exercises, or any doubts related to the course. It is strongly encouraged to send me an **email if you plan to attend** so that we optimally manage our time. If you are unable to attend the listed office hours, please email me to arrange an alternative meeting time. Should you have any doubt or issue for which you prefer a 1-to-1 meeting, please email me to find a time slot.

Discussion Sections

3 non-Block weeks

- **9/17, 5:30-7:00 pm**
- **10/10, 9:00-10:30 am**
- **10/31 , 9:00-10:30 am**

Zoom link is the same as the office hours one.
Sections are designed to be an opportunity to review the material covered in class, to ease your learning process by emphasizing the (intuition behind the) main concepts and to give you practice in solving problems and cases, which is crucial to doing well.
All sections will be recorded. All section notes, exercises and solutions, and recordings will be posted on *bCourses*.

E-mail

E-mail is strongly preferred over bCourses messages. For any email you send me, please include **"XMBA200S" in the subject**. Allow up to two working days for a reply (although the response will likely be quicker). Please, use email correspondence for simple and short questions that could reasonably be answered by email. If you have more complicated questions, please come to office hours to discuss them with me.

Softwares

We are going to work in Excel. You may also use other statistical softwares, such as R, Stata, or Python if interested. If you use alternative softwares and you have doubts on how to use them, I will do my best to answer your questions. As a side note, AI is a great resource for such softwares and learning codes. Please refer to the main syllabus for AI policy.

Feedback

Your feedback will be immensely valuable. Please let me know how things are going and if at any time you have suggestions on how I can be more effective, please let me know.

Grade Dispute Policy

In the event that a team or individual requests that an assignment or exam be re-graded, within 72 hours of it being returned, class members can submit a petition in writing. The petition should clearly document the specific issue you have with the grading, be well reasoned, and be word-processed. Please turn in the written petition and the assignment/quiz/exam at the same time. Please do not write on the assignment/quiz/exam, but rather on a separate piece of paper. We reserve the right to re-grade the whole assignment/exam.

Honor Code

As members of the UC Berkeley community, we instructors act and we expect you to act with *honesty, integrity, and respect for others*.

Special Accomodation

If you need disability-related accommodations in this class, if you have emergency medical information you wish to share me, or if you need special arrangements, please let me or professor Walker know during the first week of classes.

UC Berkeley Resources

- Information on campus policies can be found at the following link.
- Mental Health Services: asking for help is an act of courage. As an Haas student, you can find useful information at the following link.
- Addressing Sexual Violence and Sexual Harassment: UC Berkeley provides several confidential resources for victims, witnesses, and accused people of sexual violence and sexual harassment. Please check the website or call the confidential 24/7 Care Line at 510-643-2005 for urgent support.